

# Database Functions (Self-Learning)

**Q.** What is a User-Defined Function (UDF) in SQL? Explain how functions differ from Stored Procedures regarding parameters, return values, and execution contexts.

---

> **Definition to Remember**

---

## 1. Creating and Calling Functions

**Creation:** Must declare the return type explicitly.

**Calling:** Functions return a value, so they are embedded inside SQL NOT called via `CALL`.

## 2. Parameters and Return Values

- **Parameters:** Functions only accept **IN** parameters (input only no OUT or INOUT).

## 3. Procedures vs Functions

| Feature                       | Stored Procedure | User-Defined Function |
|-------------------------------|------------------|-----------------------|
| Can be called via CALL        | Yes              | No                    |
| Can return a value            | No               | Yes                   |
| Can be used in SQL statements | No               | Yes                   |

---

> **Must-Write Points (for 10 marks)**

---

> **Quick Recall**

> `UD  
Proced